

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

REAL0.08

HEALT0.34

ENERG0.59

TECHN0.61

CONS.0.67

CONS.0.96

INDUS1.01

COMM.1.17

FINAN1.52

UTILI1.57

MATER77.86

1

NVDA

BUY

\$219.74

-2.34%

8/10

The AI infrastructure buildout is a multi-year government-and-hypersca

2

GOOGL

BUY

\$344.20

+0.06%

8/10

Alphabet is quietly winning the AI infrastructure race with in-house T

3

AAPL

BUY

\$310.03

+1.45%

7/10

Fortress balance sheet and iPhone upgrade cycle offset App Store legal

Big options bets on CVX (Energy) — 51.5x normal volume, P/C 0.03, largest: CALL \$170 (3361.3x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

No major earnings this week

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

Consumer Confidence

Date: 2026-08-24

MEDIUM

VIX at 15.4 — low. Options m arket complacent ahead of sc heduled events.

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: normal · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Big money is piling into Real Estate (XLRE) with an incredibly bullish call-heavy setup, which usually happens when smart traders are betting the Fed is closer to cutting rates than the market thinks — REITs are the single most rate-sensitive trade out there, and the widening credit spreads plus bearish bets on financials tell you institutions expect the Fed to blink first.

Healthcare is the other standout, and that's likely a bet that election-year drug pricing rhetoric has already been priced in, plus you've got the GLP-1 boom and potential Medicare Advantage rate relief working in the background, while Energy call-buying lines up neatly with continued Middle East tension and the administration's warming stance toward domestic production and LNG export permits.

On the flip side, Financials are being quietly hedged despite a "pro-bank" deregulatory narrative in DC — the options market is telling you that credit stress (look at those ugly HYG and LQD put/call numbers) matters more than any rollback of Basel III, and Utilities getting dumped alongside REITs rallying is the tell that this isn't a pure "rates down" trade, it's specifically a "commercial real estate survives" trade.

That bizarre 77x put/call on Materials with 46x volume is almost certainly a single whale hedging against a China trade-deal breakdown or new tariff escalation worth watching because Materials often front-run tariff headlines by weeks.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc.	8.91/100
Leidos is a prime beneficiary of accelerating DoD IT modernization			
2.	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc.	8.91/100
SMCI remains the leading AI server OEM leveraged to Blackwell/GB2			
3.	PATH	UiPath, Inc.	8.61/100
UiPath is transitioning from pure RPA to an agentic AI automation			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 9–10	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 11–12	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 17–18	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 19–20	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy \$310.03 ▲ 1.45% 12M Price Target \$340.00 52-Week Range \$223.78 – \$344.57 Market Cap \$4.52T

AAPL: Chip Cost Hikes vs App Store Bleed — Still Bid

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock ripped +1.45% to \$310 on heavy volume (53M shares, well above the ~40M average) — and the options market is screaming bullish. That \$310 strike call saw 103K contracts trade at 9.6x open interest — meaning traders opened 9x more new bets than what existed before. Somebody with real money thinks this keeps grinding higher near-term.
- The two headlines look contradictory but tell one story: App Store commissions dropped 18% (legal losses from the Epic/DOJ cases are biting), BUT Samsung and TSMC are hiking chip prices because Nvidia/Apple/Tesla demand is overwhelming supply. Translation: hardware demand is white-hot, software toll booth is leaking.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the tension you need to understand: Apple's business is quietly transforming under your feet. The App Store 30% cut — which was pure margin, basically free money — is getting regulated and litigated into oblivion (EU Digital Markets Act, US DOJ case, Epic ruling). An 18% drop in commission revenue is meaningful because Services was supposed to be the growth engine justifying the premium multiple. BUT — and this is why the stock is up, not down — the chip price hike news signals demand is so strong that suppliers have pricing power, which typically means Apple is ordering aggressively for a big iPhone cycle. The market is betting hardware strength + AI features on new iPhones will more than offset the App Store margin compression. Watch whether Apple can pass those chip cost hikes to consumers without denting unit demand — that's the whole ballgame for next 6 months.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

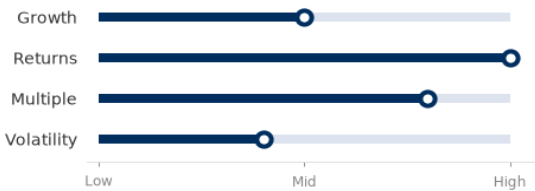
Two big political overhangs right now: (1) The DOJ antitrust case against Apple is grinding forward — if the court forces Apple to open up iMessage, the App Store further, or default browser choices, Services revenue takes another leg down. (2) Trump-era tariff policy on China-assembled electronics is still the sword hanging over margins — Apple has diversified to India and Vietnam, but ~80% of iPhones still touch China. Any tariff escalation this fall (there's chatter about a new round tied to semiconductor policy) hits Apple's cost structure directly. On the flip side, the CHIPS Act money flowing to TSMC Arizona actually helps Apple long-term — it de-risks their supply chain and gives them political cover.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$310.03
12M Price Target	\$340.00
Upside / (Downside)	+9.7%
Market Cap	\$4.52T
FY2026E Revenue	\$428M
FY2027E Revenue	\$458M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.45
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	41.6x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$325.00	\$315.00	\$295.00
6 Months	\$355.00	\$330.00	\$280.00
1 Year	\$385.00	\$340.00	\$260.00
2 Years	\$440.00	\$375.00	\$240.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$425.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$750.00	\$525.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.5% this week) and Healthcare are catching a defensive bid — classic late-cycle rotation as investors get nervous about growth stocks. Energy specifically is riding geopolitical tension and OPEC discipline.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services (-0.71%) and Consumer Discretionary (-2.42%) are getting sold — that USA Today piece about "Magnificent 7 struggling" reflects real rotation OUT of mega-cap tech. Apple is fighting this tape and winning today, which is notable.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly moving from growth to value/defensives. Apple's outperformance vs its Mag 7 peers today suggests it's being treated as a defensive tech name — the balance sheet fortress (\$60B+ cash) makes it a safety trade within tech.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the chip pricing story, TSM (Taiwan Semi) is the cleaner beneficiary — they supply Apple's chips and just got pricing power. AVGO (Broadcom) also benefits from Apple's RF chip orders.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GOOGL (Alphabet): 13F filings show hedge funds piling in — the AI narrative there is cleaner right now with Gemini gaining ground and no App Store overhang.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the reference asset for AI capex — the chip demand story lifting Apple lifts Nvidia 10x more directly.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is LAGGING the AI leaders (NVDA, GOOGL) year-to-date but LEADING the defensive tech trade. That's a tell — it's becoming the "safe" way to own tech, not the "growth" way. That's fine for capital preservation but caps your upside vs. buying the actual AI winners.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$295-305 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Services revenue growth turns negative or China iPhone ban escalates

Hedging: Long-dated \$280 puts or pair with short QQQ on Mag 7 weakness

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$171.54 ▼ 0.59%	12M Price Target \$185.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$412.22B
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PLTR: Cooling After Karp Bump, Policy Still Friendly

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is down 0.6% and has drifted lower for three straight days after popping to \$179 on Aug 13. Translation: the Karp "good news" from Motley Fool this morning isn't enough to reignite the rally — buyers are exhausted at these levels and the stock is digesting recent gains.
- Options flow is quietly bullish though — that big \$172.5 call buy expiring this month (4.4x the existing open interest, meaning traders are opening brand new bullish bets, not closing old ones) tells me somebody's betting on a bounce back above \$175 in the next couple weeks.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: PLTR has become the poster child for the AI-meets-government-spending trade, and right now that trade is in a holding pattern waiting for the next catalyst. The stock is sitting at 64% of its 52-week range — not overheated, not oversold — which usually means it needs a real news catalyst (contract win, earnings, policy announcement) to break out. With the current administration still pushing aggressive defense modernization and AI adoption across federal agencies, the fundamental tailwind is intact, but at a \$412B market cap, PLTR needs to keep landing whale-sized contracts to justify the multiple. Watch for: any DoD or ICE contract announcements this fall — those are the real fuel.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one to watch is the FY2027 defense authorization and appropriations cycle — the Pentagon's AI and software modernization budget lines are where PLTR eats, and early markups suggest continued expansion of the Chief Digital and AI Office (CDAO) budget. Also on the radar: the administration's ongoing push to consolidate federal data systems under AI platforms (executive orders from earlier this year explicitly favor "commercial off-the-shelf" AI solutions — which is PLTR's Foundry and AIP to a T). Headwind to watch: any bipartisan privacy legislation or AI oversight bill that adds compliance friction to government AI deployments — that would slow their sales cycle even if they'd ultimately comply.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

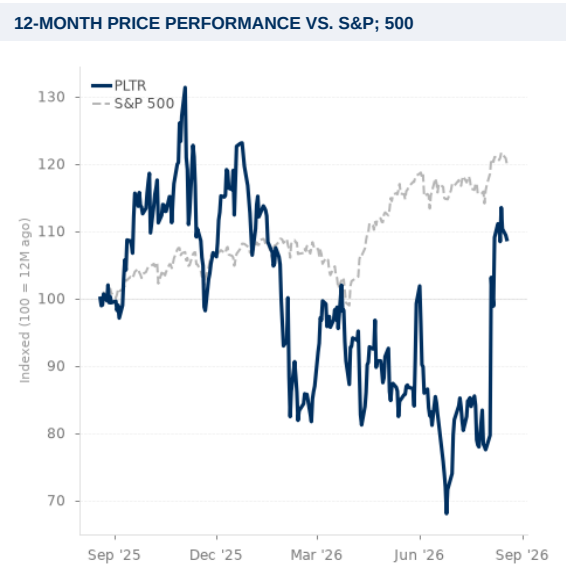
This stock is expensive by every conventional measure — trading around 85x forward sales, meaning investors are paying \$85 for every \$1 of revenue the company will book next year. For comparison, most enterprise software peers trade at \$10-15 per \$1 of revenue. The bull case says that's justified because PLTR is basically the only pure-play way to bet on government AI, and their commercial business is growing 40%+ — but at this multiple, one bad quarter or one lost contract could take 30% off the stock in a week.

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-19 13:23 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$171.54
12M Price Target	\$185.00
Upside / (Downside)	+7.8%
Market Cap	\$412.22B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.62
FY2027E EPS	\$0.88
Fwd P/E	276.7x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$195.00	\$175.00	\$155.00
6 Months	\$220.00	\$185.00	\$140.00
1 Year	\$250.00	\$190.00	\$120.00
2 Years	\$320.00	\$220.00	\$100.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$300.00	\$80.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$400.00	\$60.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+1.76% today, +4.51% for the week) — likely oil price strength and continued fossil fuel policy support under the current administration. Healthcare also catching a bid (+1.60%), possibly on drug pricing clarity.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-2.42% for the week) and Communication Services — classic signal that consumers are pulling back and mega-cap tech is losing some steam.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating OUT of high-multiple tech (where PLTR lives) and INTO energy and defensives. That's a subtle headwind for PLTR — even with great fundamentals, if the rotation continues, multiple compression is the risk.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the government AI thesis but want less valuation risk, look at defense primes with growing software businesses — Lockheed, RTX, or infrastructure plays like Arista Networks (ANET), which the Motley Fool piece today directly compared to PLTR.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- ANET (Arista Networks): Networking backbone for AI data centers — benefits from the same AI capex wave but trades at a much more reasonable multiple.
- MU (Micron): Highlighted in the Zacks piece alongside PLTR — memory chips are the picks-and-shovels play on AI infrastructure buildout.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR has been the leader of the AI-software pack for months, but it's now lagging its own recent highs while networking and semi names keep making new ones. That's a subtle tell — the market may be starting to prefer AI infrastructure (chips, networking) over AI software applications at these valuations.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I love the business, I don't love the price. Cautiously optimistic, not pounding the table.

POSITION SIZE: Keep it small — 2-3% of portfolio. This stock can swing 10% on any given week, so size it to where a 30% drawdown wouldn't wreck your sleep.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for a pullback to \$150-160 to add meaningfully. If you don't own any and want a starter, buy a third here and save dry powder for dips.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm watching: Q3 earnings (early November) and any major DoD contract announcements this fall.

WHEN TO BAIL: If revenue growth drops below 30% YoY, if they lose a major government contract, or if Karp announces he's stepping back. Also, if the stock breaks below \$140 on heavy volume, the technical picture gets ugly fast.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — set a mental stop-loss at \$150 and just sell if it breaks. For more sophisticated protection, buy a put option 10-15% below current price expiring in 3-6 months — that's like buying insurance where you pay a premium to cap your downside.

Amazon.com, Inc.
AMZN NASDAQ

Buy	\$259.45 ▼ 0.71%	12M Price Target \$295.00	52-Week Range \$196.00 – \$287.20	Market Cap \$2.80T
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AMZN: Drone Expansion + AI Capex Race, But Consumer Wobbles

WHAT HAPPENED

- AMZN quietly bled 3% over the past week even though nothing bad happened — this is a "cooling off" tape, not a "something's broken" tape. Consumer Discretionary as a whole is down 2.4% on the week, so this is sector rotation, not an AMZN-specific problem. Money is flowing OUT of tech/consumer and INTO energy and healthcare (defensive + inflation hedge behavior).
- Two real headlines matter: (1) Amazon expanding drone delivery to ~500 locales — that's the logistics moat widening, and (2) Harvard's endowment disclosed a \$2.2B tech stake, which signals smart institutional money is still leaning into mega-cap tech even on the pullback.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Bezos \$346M share sale on Aug 3 at \$286 basically marked the local top — that's not a coincidence, insiders often sell into strength on pre-scheduled plans, but the market noticed. Here's what to think about: the options flow is bullish (put/call at 0.62 means way more calls than puts being bought), yet insiders are selling — that tells me institutions are positioning for a rebound while insiders are just harvesting gains on a scheduled basis. The drone expansion to 500 locales is a bigger deal than the market is pricing in — this is Amazon finally cashing in on years of FAA lobbying, and it directly threatens UPS/FedEx margins. If AWS Q3 comes in with 18%+ growth (driven by the Anthropic partnership and AI inference demand), this stock re-rates back to \$285+ fast.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one: FAA Part 108 rules on Beyond Visual Line of Sight (BVLOS) drone operations — the expansion to 500 locales suggests Amazon is getting regulatory green lights it couldn't get 2 years ago, which is a massive tailwind. On the antitrust front, the current administration has largely deprioritized the FTC's Khan-era case against Amazon — that's a huge quiet win worth maybe \$30-50/share in removed overhang. Watch also the ongoing China tariff situation: Amazon's 3P marketplace sellers eat tariff costs, so if the administration ratchets up Section 301 tariffs on Chinese consumer goods this fall, retail margins get squeezed even as AWS accelerates.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$259.45
12M Price Target	\$295.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.7%
Market Cap	\$2.80T
FY2026E Revenue	\$745M
FY2027E Revenue	\$820M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.10
Fwd P/E	37.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$275.00	\$262.00	\$248.00
6 Months	\$310.00	\$285.00	\$240.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$295.00	\$230.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$340.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$425.00	\$250.00
10 Years	\$850.00	\$600.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.5% week) — driven by geopolitical tension and inflation reacceleration fears; Healthcare (+1% week) — defensive rotation plus GLP-2 pipeline optimism.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-2.4% week) and Communication Services (-0.7%) — classic late-cycle rotation as investors worry about consumer strength and AI capex ROI.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving from growth/tech into defensives and energy — this is a "risk-off but not panic" pattern. For AMZN specifically, this means the pullback is macro-driven, not fundamental, which is actually a buying opportunity if you believe in the 12-month story.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the drone expansion is real, the second-order play is data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) and power infrastructure (VST, CEG) — Amazon needs both to execute its AI + logistics vision.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- XOM (Exxon): Energy sector leader benefiting from oil price recovery and administration's pro-drilling stance
- LLY (Eli Lilly): Healthcare rotation beneficiary, GLP-1 franchise still expanding

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is lagging the mega-cap tech pack this week, but it's outperforming pure-play retail (Target, etc.) — this tells me the market is discounting Amazon as "half retail, half AI" and getting nervous about the retail half. When AWS puts up a strong Q3 print, that narrative flips fast.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio (core holding)

Entry Points: \$250-255 on pullbacks; add aggressively sub-\$240

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: AWS growth decelerates below 15% or FTC revives major antitrust case

Hedging: Buy \$240 puts 3-6 months out, or pair-trade short XLY (consumer discretionary ETF)

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Hold	\$143.34 ▼ 1.98%	12M Price Target \$155.00	52-Week Range \$104.83 – \$225.64	Market Cap \$1.89T
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SPCX: Space ETF Cools as Yields Spike Pre-Jackson Hole

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX fell 2% yesterday, and the culprit is pretty clearly the bond market — Treasury yields (the interest rate the US government pays to borrow) spiked ahead of the Jackson Hole meeting (an annual Fed conference where they hint at rate policy). When yields jump, speculative growth names like space stocks get hit first because future profits are worth less when you can earn more risk-free.
- The Barron's piece on space debris being "the next stock play" is a subtle tell — Wall Street is starting to price in regulatory risk around orbital congestion, which cuts both ways for SPCX holdings.

WHY IT MATTERS

The dip isn't about space fundamentals — it's macro. But here's what to actually think about: SPCX holds a basket of pure-play space names (Rocket Lab, Iridium, Planet, Intuitive Machines, etc.), and this sector is uniquely dependent on two things — government contracts and cheap capital. The Trump administration's "Golden Dome" missile defense initiative and the FY2026 defense budget both funnel billions toward space-based systems, which is a direct tailwind. But the options flow is telling — a 0.72 put/call ratio with unusual call buying at \$142-145 strikes suggests traders are betting this pullback is a buying opportunity into Jackson Hole, not the start of a bigger break. ===IMPLICATIONS_END===

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Three policy angles matter right now: (1) The Golden Dome missile defense architecture — Congress appropriated initial funding and the Space Force is expected to award major contracts through 2027, directly benefiting SPCX holdings like Rocket Lab and Redwire. (2) FAA commercial launch licensing reform is moving through the House — if it passes, it cuts launch approval time roughly in half, which is huge for cadence-dependent names. (3) Watch the emerging bipartisan push on space debris/orbital traffic management — new rules could raise compliance costs but also create moats for established operators already investing in tracking tech.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

SPCX trades as a basket, so traditional P/E doesn't really apply — most holdings are unprofitable growth stories. At \$143, it's at 32% of its 52-week range, meaning it's closer to the lows than the highs, which is actually reasonable value if you believe the sector's earnings power in 2027-2028. The ETF is essentially a call option on commercial space + defense space converging — expensive on today's numbers, fair on 2027 numbers if government contracts convert.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

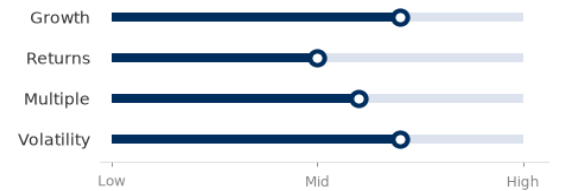
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-19 13:23 UTC

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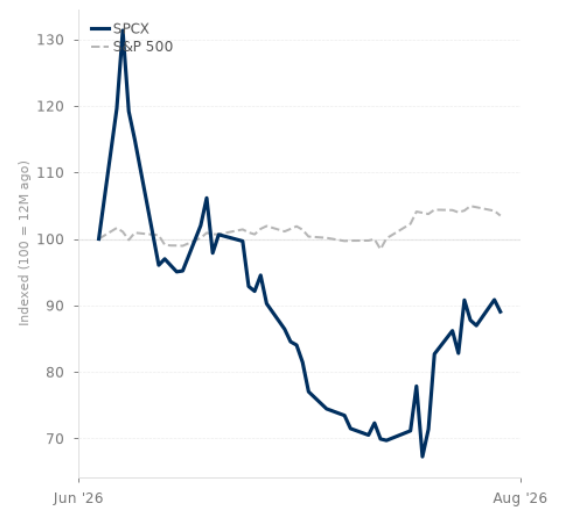
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$143.34
12M Price Target	\$155.00
Upside / (Downside)	+8.1%
Market Cap	\$1.89T
FY2026E Revenue	\$0K
FY2027E Revenue	\$0K
FY2026E EPS	\$0.00
FY2027E EPS	\$0.00
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$155.00	\$145.00	\$132.00
6 Months	\$175.00	\$155.00	\$125.00
1 Year	\$200.00	\$165.00	\$120.00
2 Years	\$240.00	\$185.00	\$110.00
5 Years	\$350.00	\$240.00	\$100.00
10 Years	\$550.00	\$350.00	\$90.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+1.76%) and Healthcare (+1.60%) — classic defensive/inflation-hedge rotation as yields spike. Energy specifically is catching a bid on Middle East tension and OPEC discipline.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-2.42% over 5 days) and Communications — these are the rate-sensitive growth pockets getting hit by the yield surge, same headwind SPCX faces.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is fleeing long-duration growth into cash-generative defensives ahead of Jackson Hole. That's a temporary headwind for SPCX — but if Powell disappoints the hawks, this reverses in a day.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the space thesis but want less volatility, defense primes with big space exposure (LMT, NOC, Boeing) capture the government contract tailwind without the pure-play startup risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): The launch cadence leader — winning contracts SpaceX doesn't want and building a Neutron rocket that could break Falcon 9's monopoly on medium-lift.
- LUNR (Intuitive Machines): NASA lunar contracts and Artemis-adjacent work make it a policy-driven winner as long as the moon program stays funded.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is lagging its top individual holdings because ETF flows are macro-driven while the standout names are catalyst-driven. That tells you the ETF wrapper is currently a drag — but it also means when sentiment turns, SPCX should catch up fast as retail piles back into the "space theme" trade.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the multi-year story (defense space + commercial launch boom) but the near-term setup is messy with rates spiking and Jackson Hole risk.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — this is a thematic bet, not a core holding, and the volatility demands you size it small enough to sleep at night.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$135-140, especially if we get a hawkish Fed reaction — that's your gift. Above \$155 you're chasing.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalysts I'm waiting for are Golden Dome contract awards, FAA launch reform passing, and a possible SpaceX IPO announcement (which paradoxically could pump the whole theme even if it eventually pulls capital out).

WHEN TO BAIL: If we get a major launch failure at a top-3 holding, or if the FY2027 defense budget draft cuts space funding meaningfully — that's the thesis-breaker.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is owning a defensive sector alongside it (utilities or staples ETF) — when growth gets hit on rate fear, defensives usually catch a bid and cushion the blow.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Hold	\$91.53 ▼ 4.90%	12M Price Target \$105.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$82.29B
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HOOD: Tokenization Hype Cools as Crypto Rotation Fades

WHAT HAPPENED

- HOOD dropped 4.9% yesterday despite CEO Vlad Tenev doing a full media tour hyping a "tokenization supercycle" — that's actually a bearish tell. When the CEO is out cheerleading and the stock still sells off, it means the good news is already priced in and traders are using strength to take profits.
- The broader Consumer Discretionary sector was down 2.4% over 5 days and crypto-adjacent names are cooling (Securitize down 26%, Coinbase questions swirling) — HOOD is getting dragged by the crypto/fintech rotation, not company-specific bad news.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: HOOD ran from \$63 to \$153 this year on the tokenization narrative (turning real assets like stocks into blockchain tokens), and now we're in the "prove it" phase where the stock needs actual revenue to justify the multiple. The Tenev media blitz suggests management knows the narrative needs constant refueling — that's fine when it works, dangerous when it doesn't. The bigger picture: the current administration has been unusually crypto-friendly, and the SEC under new leadership has essentially greenlit tokenized equities, which is HOOD's whole growth pitch. But that tailwind is now baked in — from here you need execution (real trading volumes, real revenue) to move the stock higher, and any regulatory hiccup becomes an outsized negative.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The key thing to watch is the CLARITY Act and the broader crypto market structure legislation — if Congress formally hands crypto oversight to the CFTC (friendlier than the SEC), HOOD's tokenization business gets a massive legal moat. There's also ongoing debate around Payment for Order Flow (PFOF) — that's when Robinhood sells your trade orders to big market makers like Citadel, and it's roughly 30-40% of their revenue. The SEC under the current administration has backed off the aggressive PFOF crackdown from a few years ago, but any Democratic election win in 2028 could revive it — that's a slow-burn risk not currently priced in.

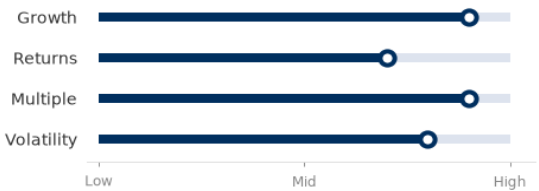
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$91.53 with an \$82B market cap, investors are paying roughly 20x forward revenue and about 50x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$50 for every \$1 of profit they'll make next year. That's rich even for a fintech in growth mode; Schwab trades around 18x earnings, Coinbase around 30x. The premium is defensible IF tokenization actually becomes a meaningful revenue line in 2027, but if crypto volumes normalize, this multiple compresses fast.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$91.53
12M Price Target	\$105.00
Upside / (Downside)	+14.7%
Market Cap	\$82.29B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,100M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.40
Fwd P/E	49.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



HOOD — Robinhood Markets, Inc. | August 19, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$105.00	\$92.00	\$82.00
6 Months	\$130.00	\$105.00	\$75.00
1 Year	\$155.00	\$115.00	\$65.00
2 Years	\$200.00	\$140.00	\$55.00
5 Years	\$320.00	\$200.00	\$45.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$275.00	\$30.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.5% week) is running on Middle East tension and the administration's drill-baby-drill push; Healthcare catching a defensive bid as growth names wobble.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-2.4% week) and Communication Services — the risk-on trade is taking a breather, and HOOD sits squarely in that basket.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of speculative fintech/crypto and INTO defensives and energy — that's a classic late-cycle move and directly explains HOOD's weakness even on good news.

RELATED PLAY: If tokenization is really the future, the infrastructure names — think COIN, and the actual blockchain rails like Chainlink — capture value regardless of which broker wins. That's the pick-and-shovel angle.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- XLE (Energy ETF): Riding oil strength and policy tailwinds from expanded drilling permits.
- XLV (Healthcare): Defensive rotation as investors de-risk from high-multiple growth.

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is LAGGING its fintech peers this week and the broader market — that's a warning sign. When a stock can't rally on its own CEO's bullish media tour, the near-term path of least resistance is sideways to down. Wait for a better setup.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — Great business, great narrative, but the easy money has been made and the risk/reward at \$91 is just okay.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — enough to participate if tokenization really takes off, small enough to survive a crypto winter.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for \$78-85, which would be a healthy 15-20% pullback from recent highs. Don't chase here — the options flow shows someone's betting on near-term weakness.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, with the key catalyst being Q4 2026 earnings showing real tokenization revenue (not just user growth).

WHEN TO BAIL: If Bitcoin drops below \$80K, if quarterly crypto revenue falls 25%+ sequentially, or if Congress reintroduces a serious PFOF ban — any of those and I'm cutting.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is just keeping the position small. If you want to get fancy, buying a cheap out-of-the-money put (insurance that pays off if the stock drops sharply) into earnings makes sense given the volatility.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Hold

\$543.67 ▼ 4.45%

12M Price Target
\$620.00

52-Week Range
\$520.26 – \$790.80

Market Cap
\$1.39T

META: Child Safety Trial Opens, Stock Cracks Below \$550

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock got hit for 4.5% today (and is down ~9% in a week) because the child safety trial in California officially kicked off — this is the big one, where states and families are arguing Meta knowingly designed Instagram to be addictive for kids. Think Big Tobacco-style "duty of care" framework, which is why WSJ is all over it.
- Second gut punch: Chamath Palihapitiya (well-known VC) publicly said top engineers want to work at "Space/Search/AI" companies, not Meta's "advertising machine." That feeds the narrative that Meta is losing the AI talent war to OpenAI, Anthropic, xAI — and it comes right after Zuck's been paying \$100M+ packages to poach people.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is actually going on: the market isn't pricing in Meta losing the trial outright — it's pricing in the **uncertainty** of what a bad verdict would force them to change. If a jury decides Instagram has a legal "duty of care" to teens, every social platform gets rewritten, and Meta's most engaging product (Reels for teens) takes a haircut. The options flow tells you smart money agrees — those unusual \$625-650 puts are people betting this doesn't bounce quickly. But zoom out: Meta still prints ~\$60B in free cash flow, trades at ~20x forward earnings (meaning you're paying \$20 for every \$1 of profit next year), and the ad business is firing. This is a headline-driven selloff on a fundamentally healthy business, which is usually where you get paid to be patient — as long as the trial doesn't produce a shock verdict.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

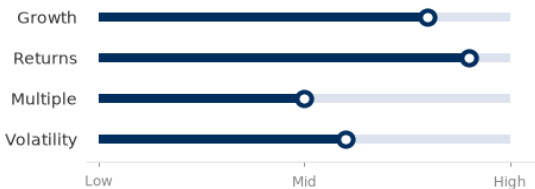
The regulatory environment is the whole story right now. KOSA (Kids Online Safety Act) has been kicking around Congress and this California trial could accelerate federal action — if the jury sides against Meta, expect bipartisan momentum for a federal duty-of-care standard, which would be a structural headwind for engagement metrics. On the flip side, the Trump administration's AI executive orders have been notably friendly to US tech champions (loose on AI training data, tough on China), which is a tailwind for Meta's Llama/AI infra spend. Also worth watching: the Samsung/TSMC chip price hikes — Meta's capex on AI data centers just got more expensive, which pressures margins in 2027.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$543.67
12M Price Target	\$620.00
Upside / (Downside)	+14.0%
Market Cap	\$1.39T
FY2026E Revenue	\$195M
FY2027E Revenue	\$222M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	19.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$590.00	\$555.00	\$495.00
6 Months	\$680.00	\$610.00	\$470.00
1 Year	\$780.00	\$620.00	\$450.00
2 Years	\$900.00	\$700.00	\$480.00
5 Years	\$1200.00	\$850.00	\$500.00
10 Years	\$2000.00	\$1200.00	\$550.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.5% on the week) is ripping on Middle East tension and supply cuts; Healthcare bid up on defensive rotation. Both are classic "risk-off" tells.

COOLING OFF: Comm Services (Meta's home sector) down 0.7% on the week, Consumer Discretionary down 2.4% — the mega-cap growth trade is losing air as folks worry about regulation and AI capex ROI.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is clearly rotating *out* of expensive growth into defensives and energy — that's a macro headwind for Meta beyond the company-specific stuff. Watch the 10-year yield; if it keeps climbing, growth multiples stay pressured.

RELATED PLAY: If you like Meta's AI thesis but hate the regulatory risk, the picks-and-shovels play is the data center/power names — think VRT (Vertiv) or the utilities feeding AI campuses. They get paid regardless of who wins the AI war.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GOOGL (Alphabet): Search AI is holding up better than feared, less regulatory heat than Meta right now on the kids issue.
- NFLX (Netflix): Ad tier is scaling and they don't have the "harm to kids" legal exposure — becoming the "clean" mega-cap media name.

META CONTEXT: Meta is lagging its peer group badly this week — down 9% while GOOGL is roughly flat. That tells you this is company-specific (trial) more than sector-wide, which is actually *good* news for the setup — it means when the overhang clears, Meta should catch back up.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the business, hate the timing. Not pounding the table until the trial narrative stabilizes.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — this is a core large-cap holding, not a swing trade, but I wouldn't oversize into a live jury trial.

ENTRY POINTS: \$520-540 range if the trial produces more bad headlines this week. That's near the 52-week low and would be a gift if the fundamentals hold.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for: trial resolution + evidence that AI capex is actually improving ad revenue per user.

WHEN TO BAIL: Jury verdict with punitive damages north of \$20B, or a Q3 earnings miss on ad revenue (which would signal advertiser pullback), or Zuck announcing another massive capex step-up without ROI clarity.

HEDGING: Simple version — buy a put option (basically insurance that pays off if the stock drops) at the \$520 strike expiring in October. Costs a small premium, protects you if the trial goes sideways. Or just keep some cash on the sidelines to average down.

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Hold	\$940.76 ▼ 7.02%	12M Price Target \$1050.00	52-Week Range \$113.46 – \$1255.00	Market Cap N/A
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MU: AI Memory Darling Cools as Chip Bears Circle

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU got smoked yesterday, down 7% — but zoom out: it ripped from \$911 to \$1,011 in four sessions before this, so this is a gut-check pullback, not a thesis break. The trigger looks like a broader "chip bears are back" narrative plus a global bond sell-off (rising yields = pain for high-multiple growth names) — meaning long-term interest rates went up, which makes future earnings worth less today in a discounted cash flow model.
- Options flow is actually telling a mixed story — the put/call ratio is 0.83 (more calls than puts = bullish tilt), but there's massive unusual PUT activity at the \$940 and \$970 strikes, meaning big money is buying downside protection right at current levels. Someone with size is hedging.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the real read: MU is now the highest-beta name in the AI trade — when the market gets nervous about tech valuations or interest rates, this stock gets whacked twice as hard because it went up twice as fast. The insider "OTHER" transactions from August 10 at \$202.71 look like they're option exercises or grant-related (the price doesn't match current levels, suggesting a stock split reference or historical grant price), so I wouldn't read those as sell signals. The bigger inference: with the stock at 72% of its 52-week range and still up ~8x from the lows, the risk/reward has flipped — the easy money is made, and from here MU trades on execution (HBM3E ramp, HBM4 timing) plus macro (yields, China). This is no longer a "buy and hold blindly" name; it's a trading vehicle with a strong secular story underneath.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

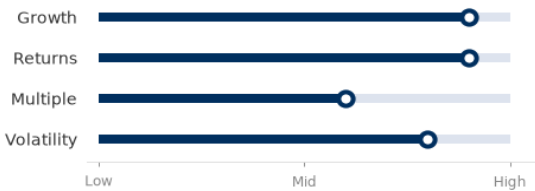
Two policy threads matter right now: (1) the CHIPS Act grants — MU already secured ~\$6.1B for Idaho and New York fabs, and any Trump administration move to renegotiate or claw back terms would hit sentiment hard, though so far the administration has kept semis as a strategic priority. (2) China export controls — tightening restrictions on selling advanced memory to China is a double-edged sword: it caps a revenue channel but also constrains Chinese competitors like CXMT, protecting MU's pricing power in HBM (high-bandwidth memory used in AI GPUs). Watch for any Commerce Department announcements on HBM export licensing this fall — that's the swing factor.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

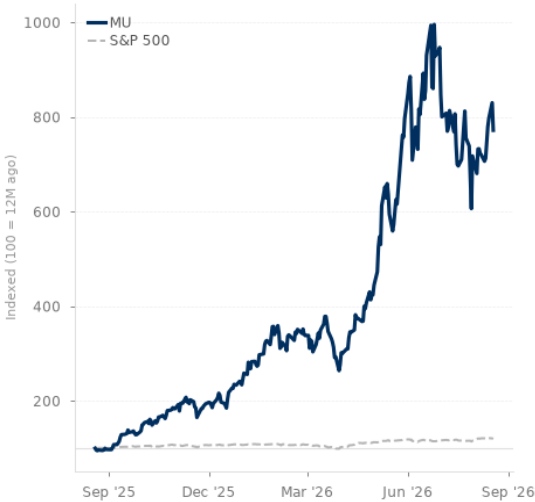
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$940.76
12M Price Target	\$1050.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.6%
Market Cap	N/A
FY2026E Revenue	\$48,500M
FY2027E Revenue	\$62,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$14.20
FY2027E EPS	\$19.50
Fwd P/E	66.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1050.00	\$960.00	\$850.00
6 Months	\$1250.00	\$1050.00	\$800.00
1 Year	\$1400.00	\$1150.00	\$750.00
2 Years	\$1700.00	\$1300.00	\$700.00
5 Years	\$2200.00	\$1600.00	\$600.00
10 Years	\$3000.00	\$2000.00	\$500.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+1.76%) and Healthcare (+1.60%) — classic defensive/late-cycle rotation as investors trim high-multiple tech. Energy is also getting a bid from geopolitical risk premium and steady administration support for domestic production.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-2.42% over 5 days) and Communication Services — high yields hurt anything consumer-facing, and mega-cap tech is wobbling.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly leaving high-beta AI winners (MU, SanDisk, Credo all down together per the IBD headline) and moving into defensive value. This is a "reduce risk into a nervous tape" trade, not a full-blown regime change — yet.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the MU story but want less volatility, look at AMAT or LRCX (semi equipment makers) — they benefit from every fab MU and TSMC build with CHIPS Act money, but they trade at cheaper multiples and are less directly exposed to memory pricing.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the tide that lifts all AI boats — every HBM chip MU sells basically goes onto an NVDA GPU, so watch NVDA guidance like a hawk for MU signal.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI silicon momentum with hyperscalers is diversifying the AI trade away from pure GPU plays — a tailwind for memory suppliers broadly.

MU CONTEXT: MU is lagging today because it's the highest-beta AI name — when the group sells off, MU falls hardest. But look at the 5-day trend: it was leading on the way up too. This is a "high torque" name — great in rallies, painful in pullbacks. If NVDA holds up next week, MU snaps back fast.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$850-900 on macro pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: HBM pricing rolls over or Samsung wins meaningful NVDA share

Hedging: Pair with SOXS or buy Jan puts on SMH to cover sector risk

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold \$336.87 ▼ 0.72% 12M Price Target \$380.00 52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83

Market Cap \$1.33T

TSLA: Cybercab Buzz Meets Robot Competition Reality

WHAT HAPPENED

- Tesla inked a deal with Sweden's Einride to deploy 500 Semi trucks — solid validation for the Semi program, but 500 trucks is a rounding error on a \$1.33T market cap. The market yawned (-0.72%) because it's already priced in a lot of "future stuff working."
- The bigger story: Unitree, a Chinese humanoid robot maker, IPO'd in Shanghai and popped 460% on day one. That's a direct shot across Optimus's bow — Musk's robot thesis just got a well-funded, cheaper competitor with home-field advantage in the world's biggest manufacturing market.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Unitree IPO matters more than people realize — humanoid robots are supposed to be Tesla's next trillion-dollar leg (Musk has literally said Optimus could be worth more than the car business). Now there's a public-market comp getting funded aggressively by Chinese capital, which means Tesla can't just cruise on hype anymore. Meanwhile, the "Musk Bank" story (a 6% yield product via X/xAI ecosystem) shows Elon is stretching his attention across five companies — that's a governance risk investors keep ignoring until they don't. Trading at 20% of its 52-week range tells you sentiment is soggy despite the narrative firepower — the market is waiting for hard numbers on Cybercab deliveries and FSD unsupervised approval before rewarding the stock again.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big overhang is the EV tax credit sunset — the \$7,500 consumer credit expired September 30, 2025 under the Trump administration's "One Big Beautiful Bill," and we're now seeing the demand hangover in Q3/Q4 2026 numbers. On the flip side, the administration's push to loosen federal autonomous vehicle rules (NHTSA is drafting a unified framework to preempt state-by-state rules) is a massive tailwind for Cybercab — if that framework lands in Q4, Tesla can scale robotaxis nationally without fighting 50 different state regulators. Also watch Section 301 tariff decisions on Chinese EV components — Tesla's Shanghai gigafactory and battery supply chain get hit both ways depending on how carve-outs shake out.

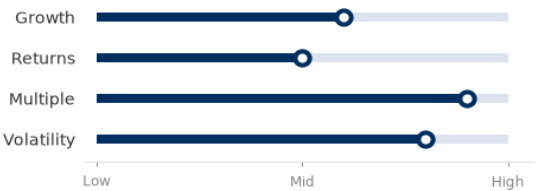
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~118x forward earnings, you're paying \$118 for every \$1 of profit Tesla will make next year — versus roughly 25x for the S&P 500 and 8x for legacy automakers like Ford and GM. That premium is only defensible if you believe Optimus, Cybercab, and FSD licensing become real revenue lines in the next 3 years. The auto business alone would justify maybe \$120-150/share — everything above that is a bet on the AI/robotics narrative delivering.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$336.87
12M Price Target	\$380.00
Upside / (Downside)	+12.8%
Market Cap	\$1.33T
FY2026E Revenue	\$118,000M
FY2027E Revenue	\$142,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.85
FY2027E EPS	\$3.90
Fwd P/E	118.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$365.00	\$340.00	\$310.00
6 Months	\$450.00	\$370.00	\$280.00
1 Year	\$520.00	\$380.00	\$250.00
2 Years	\$650.00	\$420.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$900.00	\$500.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$1500.00	\$700.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+1.76%) is ripping on geopolitical/supply concerns and Healthcare is bid on defensive rotation — classic late-cycle behavior when investors get nervous.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-2.42% over 5 days) is where TSLA lives, and it's the worst-performing sector this week. That's a headwind — when discretionary rolls over, high-multiple names in it get hit hardest.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of growth/discretionary and INTO defensive sectors (Energy, Healthcare, Staples). That's a risk-off signal, and TSLA typically underperforms in that tape until sentiment flips back.

RELATED PLAY: If you want AI/robotics exposure without Tesla's single-CEO risk, look at NVDA (still the picks-and-shovels play) or ABB/ROK on the industrial automation side — they benefit whether Tesla OR Unitree wins the robot race.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GEV (GE Vernova): Riding the power/grid buildout for AI data centers and EV charging — direct policy tailwind from infrastructure spending.
- BYD (BYD Co): Eating global EV share, especially in Europe and emerging markets, while Tesla's growth stalls.

TSLA CONTEXT: TSLA is lagging its megacap tech peers (NVDA, META, GOOGL all near highs) and sitting at just 20% of its 52-week range. That relative weakness tells you the market is skeptical of the near-term auto story and isn't yet ready to pay full price for the AI narrative. Until earnings prove the transition, TSLA trades like a show-me stock.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$300-315 on macro pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Cybercab rollout delays past 2027 or FSD regulatory reversal

Hedging: Long BYD or a broad EV ETF to offset China competition risk

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$219.74 ▼ 2.34%	12M Price Target \$260.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$5.32T
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NVDA: Dip Looks Like Noise, Not a Trend Break

WHAT HAPPENED

- NVDA dropped 2.3% yesterday to \$219.74 — but this isn't NVDA-specific drama. The Yahoo headline flagged a "global bond sell-off" which basically means interest rates are rising globally, and when rates rise, expensive growth stocks like NVDA get hit hardest (because future profits are worth less when you can earn more risk-free today).
- Bank of America called the pullback a "compelling opportunity" this morning — Wall Street analysts are treating this as a buy-the-dip moment, not a fundamental problem with the business.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what the tape is really telling you: NVDA is still sitting at 77% of its 52-week range with a \$5.3 trillion market cap — this is a controlled pullback, not a breakdown. The unusual put buying (traders paying up for downside protection) at the \$232-\$242 strikes suggests big money is hedging near-term event risk — likely the next earnings print or a potential China export announcement — but they're not dumping shares. The bigger picture: hyperscaler capex (what Amazon, Microsoft, Google, and Meta spend on data centers) is still running north of \$400B annually, and NVDA captures the majority of every AI training dollar spent. When the stock dips on macro noise while the fundamental demand story is intact, that's usually a gift.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The single biggest policy variable is still China export controls — the Trump administration has been using chip access as a negotiating chip in the ongoing trade talks, and any tightening (or loosening) of what NVDA can sell into China moves the stock 5%+ in a day. Watch also the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions in the Senate — expanded domestic semiconductor incentives would benefit NVDA's TSMC-Arizona production pipeline. On the flip side, the Meta \$1.4T antitrust trial mentioned in the news matters indirectly: if Big Tech gets hit with structural remedies, their AI capex budgets could get squeezed, and NVDA is the direct beneficiary of those budgets.

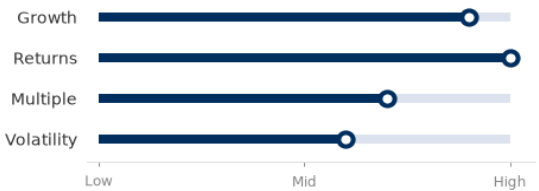
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~37x forward earnings, you're paying \$37 for every \$1 of profit NVDA will make next year — that sounds expensive until you remember they're growing revenue 40%+ and gross margins are above 70% (meaning for every \$1 of chips they sell, 70 cents is pure profit before overhead). Compared to other mega-cap tech at 28-32x with slower growth, NVDA's premium is earned. Not cheap, but not stupid — the valuation is justified as long as data center demand doesn't crack.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$219.74
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+18.3%
Market Cap	\$5.32T
FY2027E Revenue	\$235M
FY2028E Revenue	\$295M
FY2027E EPS	\$5.85
FY2028E EPS	\$7.40
Fwd P/E	37.6x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$240.00	\$225.00	\$205.00
6 Months	\$265.00	\$240.00	\$190.00
1 Year	\$300.00	\$260.00	\$180.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$310.00	\$170.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$400.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$250.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+1.76%) and Healthcare (+1.60%) — energy is riding higher rates and geopolitical premium, healthcare is getting a Moderna-driven biotech bid. This is classic defensive rotation.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-2.42% over 5 days) and Communication Services — rising bond yields are punishing anything rate-sensitive or consumer-facing.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of high-multiple tech into value and defensives because of the bond sell-off — this is why NVDA is down. It's not company-specific, it's a macro/rates story, which means it usually reverses quickly when yields stabilize.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI story, the "picks and shovels" plays around NVDA — power/utility names supplying data centers, and networking companies like Arista or Broadcom — often outperform on the second-order buildout.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- XOM (Exxon Mobil): Energy leading on higher oil prices and the classic "rates up, energy up" trade.
- LLY (Eli Lilly): Healthcare bid getting stronger as investors rotate defensive.

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is lagging today but leading over the year — down 2.3% on a macro day while still trading at 77% of its 52-week range tells you this is profit-taking, not distribution. When rates stabilize, NVDA is typically first to bounce because the fundamental story keeps working.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — I'm pounding the table on the multi-year AI infrastructure story, but I'm not chasing \$220 with both hands when bonds are selling off.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that a 20% drawdown doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on any pullback to \$210-215. If we get a China scare or a broader tech sell-off down to \$195-200, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, with the next earnings print as the key catalyst — watch data center revenue guidance and gross margin trajectory.

WHEN TO BAIL: If data center revenue growth drops below 20% year-over-year, or if two of the top four hyperscalers explicitly cut AI capex guidance, the thesis is broken and I'm trimming aggressively.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy put options 10% below current price for 3-6 months out. Think of it as insurance: you pay a small premium, and if the stock crashes, the puts pay off and offset your losses.

Alphabet Inc.
GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	\$344.20 ▲ 0.06%	12M Price Target \$385.00	52-Week Range \$196.60 – \$408.61	Market Cap \$4.21T
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GOOGL: Marvell Chip Deal Signals Custom Silicon Push

WHAT HAPPENED

- Marvell just gave Google the option to buy a \$12.2B stake in a custom chip deal — this is HUGE. It means Alphabet is doubling down on making its own AI chips instead of buying from Nvidia, which lowers their long-term AI costs and gives them a real moat. The stock barely moved (+0.06%) because the market's still digesting it, but this is the kind of vertical integration that quietly compounds.
- The \$3.5B Anthropic-tied data center loan and Alphabet's "small data deal" chatter both point in the same direction: the AI infrastructure buildout is accelerating, and Google's cloud/chip stack is at the center of it.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Marvell deal is the real story — Alphabet is building a Nvidia alternative in-house, and that structurally improves margins over time (they're not paying the ~75% gross margin Nvidia tax on every AI workload). This probably means Google Cloud's profitability inflects higher over the next 4-6 quarters, which is exactly what bulls have been waiting for. The bearish options flow (put/call at 0.63 skewed to puts, plus that unusual \$390 put) tells me short-term traders are hedging into the August OpEx — not a fundamental bet against the company. And Brin's insider selling looks like scheduled 10b5-1 stuff (the \$0 price tag suggests gifts/trusts, not open-market dumps), so I wouldn't read too much into it.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big overhang is still the DOJ antitrust remedy phase — the government has been pushing for Chrome divestiture and Android restrictions, and the appeals process is grinding through 2026. But here's the flip side: the current administration's AI executive orders have generally favored US-based AI infrastructure (fast-tracking data center permitting, export controls on chips to China), which directly benefits Alphabet's TPU/cloud buildout. Also worth watching: any renewed noise on Section 230 reform or an EU Digital Markets Act enforcement action — those are the tail risks that could clip ad revenue.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~35x forward earnings, you're paying \$35 for every \$1 of profit Alphabet will make next year — that's a premium to the S&P (~22x) but a DISCOUNT to Microsoft (~38x) and Meta (~28x adjusted for growth). Given Alphabet has the best AI chip stack, YouTube growing double-digits, and Waymo scaling as a call option nobody's paying for, this feels reasonable — not cheap, but not stretched. The market's basically pricing in "steady eddie AI winner" and ignoring the optionality.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

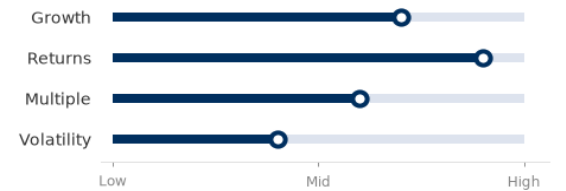
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-19 13:23 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$344.20
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.9%
Market Cap	\$4.21T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$478M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.40
Fwd P/E	34.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$365.00	\$350.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$375.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$440.00	\$385.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$520.00	\$430.00	\$270.00
5 Years	\$750.00	\$550.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1200.00	\$800.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+1.76%) and Healthcare (+1.60%) leading — classic defensive/inflation-hedge rotation, probably reacting to some macro data or Fed commentary. Energy strength also hints at data center power demand narrative.

COOLING OFF: Comm Services (-0.31%, -0.71% 5D) and Consumer Discretionary (-0.33%) — GOOGL sits in Comm Services, so the sector's mild weakness is why the stock is flat despite good news.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating out of mega-cap tech/comm services and into defensives + energy. That's a short-term headwind for GOOGL, but it's rotation noise, not a fundamental shift. When rates or macro fears ease, this reverses fast.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI chip vertical-integration story, Marvell (MRVL) is the direct beneficiary of this deal. Data center REITs (EQIX, DLR) also win as hyperscaler capex keeps ripping.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MRVL (Marvell): Direct winner from the \$12.2B Google chip option — this is validation of their custom silicon business.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI infrastructure king, but the Marvell/Google deal is a shot across the bow long-term.

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL is lagging its mega-cap peers slightly on the 5-day (Comm Services -0.71%), but it's been a leader YTD sitting at 70% of its 52-week range. This is consolidation, not weakness — the stock is digesting a huge run and building a base. That's usually a setup for the next leg higher once a catalyst hits (likely Q3 earnings or a Gemini product event).

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — Alphabet has the best combination of profitable core business + real AI infrastructure + hidden optionality (Waymo, YouTube) in mega-cap tech, and it's trading at a discount to peers.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio. Big enough to matter, small enough that the DOJ tail risk doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add at \$330-340 on any macro pullback. If it breaks \$325 on non-fundamental news, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Catalyst: Q3 earnings (Cloud margin expansion), any Waymo commercial milestone, or DOJ remedy clarity.

WHEN TO BAIL: Two consecutive quarters of Search revenue declining YoY, OR a DOJ order forcing Chrome/Android divestiture, OR Cloud growth decelerating below 25%.

HEDGING: Buy cheap out-of-the-money puts (around \$325 strike, a few months out) as insurance — costs a little, but protects you if antitrust news hits. Or just don't oversize the position.

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy	\$216.00 ▼ 7.82%	12M Price Target \$260.00	52-Week Range \$61.44 – \$329.88	Market Cap \$193.87B
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MRVL: Google Deal Is Huge, But AI Selloff Masks It

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL dropped 7.8% yesterday alongside a broader AI-stock selloff — but the real news dropped this morning: Reuters is reporting Marvell gave Google an OPTION to buy a \$12.2B stake tied to a custom chip deal. That's not a small thing — it means Google is committing to Marvell as a long-term custom silicon partner (custom silicon = chips designed specifically for one customer's AI workloads, way more profitable than generic chips).
- The CEO also bought \$1.8M of stock right before the drop — insiders don't put personal money in unless they think it's going higher. That timing matters.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the disconnect worth thinking about: the market sold this off with the broader AI trade, but the Google news is a genuine game-changer that hasn't been priced in yet. When a hyperscaler (Google, Amazon, Microsoft — the giant cloud companies) gives you an equity option, they're basically saying "we're locking you in as a strategic supplier" — that's the kind of relationship that turns MRVL from a chip vendor into critical infrastructure. The bearish options flow (that unusual \$275 put buy) suggests some big players are hedging near-term downside, but institutional ownership at 82% tells you the smart money isn't running for the exits. Watch the next 48 hours — if the stock reclaims \$225 on volume, the Google news wins; if it breaks \$210, the AI-bubble crowd takes over the narrative short-term.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

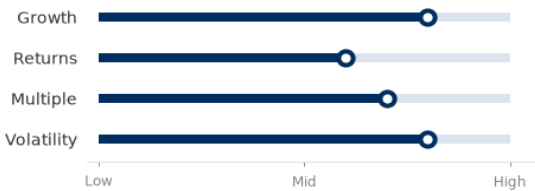
The CHIPS Act money is still flowing and MRVL is a direct beneficiary — the Commerce Department has been steering funds toward US-designed semis for AI, and custom silicon is exactly what Washington wants scaled domestically. The bigger swing factor right now is the Trump administration's China chip export policy — Marvell has China exposure in networking and storage chips, so any tightening of export controls (rumored to be under review this fall) could clip 10-15% of revenue. Also watch the AI Diffusion Rule successor framework — if it gets watered down, hyperscaler capex accelerates further, which is pure fuel for MRVL.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$216.00
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+20.4%
Market Cap	\$193.87B
FY2026E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$10,500M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.85
FY2027E EPS	\$3.90
Fwd P/E	75.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$240.00	\$222.00	\$195.00
6 Months	\$285.00	\$250.00	\$180.00
1 Year	\$330.00	\$260.00	\$170.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$310.00	\$160.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$420.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+1.76%) is running on oil prices and defense/grid spending — the administration's "energy dominance" push is real money. Healthcare bouncing on defensive rotation as people trim AI winners.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services and Consumer Discretionary are bleeding — that's classic "risk off" behavior when big tech gets hit. AI names across the board took it on the chin yesterday.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of high-multiple AI names and INTO energy and defensives — this is a positioning move, not a fundamental one, which means it usually reverses within 1-2 weeks once earnings catalysts return.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the MRVL custom-silicon thesis, look at ALAB (Astera Labs) and CRDO (Credo) — they make the connectivity chips that plug into Marvell's AI systems, and they move in the same direction but with smaller market caps (bigger upside, bigger risk).

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Winning the custom AI chip narrative with Google and Meta relationships already generating real revenue — MRVL is chasing this playbook
- ANET (Arista Networks): AI networking pure-play that keeps beating and raising, benefiting from the same data center buildout

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL has been LAGGING AVGO on the custom silicon story — the Google option news is essentially Marvell catching up. If the market recognizes this as a "Marvell is now in the AVGO club" moment, the stock re-rates higher. If not, it stays in AVGO's shadow.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — The Google deal is a legitimate long-term win but the near-term chart looks ugly and the AI trade is wobbling, so I'm confident but not pounding the table.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — big enough to matter if it works, small enough that a 30% drawdown doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd scale in — buy some at \$216 today, save dry powder for \$200-205 if the AI selloff continues. Don't chase above \$235 until we see the Google deal in an SEC filing.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst you're waiting for is the Google contract revenue actually showing up in the numbers (probably 2-3 quarters out) and FY27 guidance getting raised.

WHEN TO BAIL: If a major hyperscaler cuts capex guidance, if the Google option gets pulled or restructured, or if the stock breaks and closes below \$180 on heavy volume — those are your exit signals.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is just keeping the position modest. If you want protection, buy a small amount of SOXX (semiconductor ETF) puts 3 months out — cheaper than MRVL-specific puts and covers you if the whole sector rolls over.

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	LDOS Leidos Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$143.48 · 1M: +34.1% · P/S: 1.0x · Cap: \$18.0B			
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
2	SMCI Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$37.41 · 1M: +57.0% · P/S: 0.6x · Cap: \$24.2B			
■ Monitor for pullback to \$115 entry			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
3	PATH UiPath, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.6/10	BUY
Price: \$15.58 · 1M: +28.1% · P/S: 4.8x · Cap: \$8.1B			
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
4	AVAV AeroVironment, Inc. Defense Technology (Unmanned Systems)	8.2/10	BUY
Price: \$174.14 · 1M: +22.1% · P/S: 4.5x · Cap: \$8.9B			
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
5	MDB MongoDB, Inc. AI & Machine Learning (Data Infrastructure)	8.5/10	BUY
Price: \$434.62 · 1M: +34.4% · P/S: 13.4x · Cap: \$35.0B			
■ Monitor for pullback to \$310 entry			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			